

PRIYAL SHRIVASTAVA

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UX Researcher with 4+ years shaping product and AI decisions through mixed-methods research across fintech, productivity, and emerging AI systems. Focused on the intersection of user trust, responsible AI adoption, and measurable business outcomes.

EXPERIENCE

Research Assistant, [AI Institute for Societal Decision Making, CMU](#) Pittsburgh, PA May 2026 - Present

- **Synthesized 48+ papers into a task-level AI adoption framework** in partnership with MITRE, giving organizations a structured way to decide when and how to deploy AI for specific work tasks

UX Researcher, [Microsoft](#) (contract via Kadence) Bangalore, India Sep 2024 - Feb 2025

- **Delivered top 10 product priorities for Outlook mobile browser** to the product team, based on a 300+ user mixed-methods study (survey, 30 interviews across 3 geographies) surfacing the highest-impact friction points in the user journey
- **Authored a strategic white paper on responsible Copilot integration** for Outlook leadership, shifting roadmap focus toward user trust and control as the primary adoption blockers

Senior UX Researcher, [Razorpay \(YC WC15\)](#) Bangalore, India Apr 2024 - Jul 2024

- **Secured CXO sign-off on a new B2C product strategy** by leading a formative research program (3 focus groups, 25+ interviews, 1,000+ survey responses) that anchored leadership's value proposition for the roadmap
- **Uncovered onboarding mental model gaps causing SME drop-off** on a 1M+ daily-user platform through a UX audit and usability testing, with findings that directly scoped the next redesign sprint
- **Shifted research from reactive to embedded across 5+ product teams** by launching 2 customer empathy programs and running full-day workshops for 50+ PMs and designers

UX Researcher, [Razorpay \(YC WC15\)](#) Bangalore, India Oct 2022 - Mar 2024

- **Shaped Razorpay's annual business strategy** by mapping neobank value perception through 30+ in-depth interviews, surfacing user mental models leadership used to set roadmap priorities for the financial year
- **Identified detractor issues affecting 40% of dissatisfied developers** on developer documentation, through a ~4,000-respondent intercept survey across three user segments
- **Kept 10+ concurrent research initiatives on schedule** by managing timelines and dependencies across 50+ stakeholders spanning product, design, and leadership

Product Designer, [Razorpay \(YC WC15\)](#) Bangalore, India Jul 2021 - Oct 2022

- **+51% form-fill conversion, 9 min faster completion, 43% fewer support tickets**, achieved by redesigning SME onboarding for low-tech-literacy merchants across 3 rounds of usability testing

User Research Intern, [Meesho \(YC S16\)](#) Bangalore, India May 2020 - Jul 2020

- **Surfaced how language and socio-cultural context shape technology adoption** among emerging internet users through 40+ interviews with women in semi-urban and rural India for a product with 10M+ downloads, influencing how the team scoped research for the next billion users

Founding Member, [User Research India](#) Remote Aug 2020 - Present

- **Built a practitioner community of 100+ UX researchers and industry leaders** to grow research investment across the Indian tech ecosystem

AI GOVERNANCE & RESEARCH

Executive Board Member, [CMU AI Safety Initiative \(CASI\)](#) Pittsburgh, PA Jan 2026 - Present

- **Led track development for the 2026 CASI AI Policy Hackathon**, designing 4 policy prompt tracks (agentic AI fraud, corporate power concentration, training data/creator rights, deepfakes & elections)
- **Co-lead a weekly AI governance reading group with 20+ participants** exploring frontier AI risk and oversight mechanisms

1st Place, 2026 US AI Policy Hackathon, Deepfakes & Election Integrity Track Mar 2026

- **Won 1st place across 77 teams (144 participants)** for the SEAL IT Act, a federal framework for synthetic election media with circuit-breaker amplification controls and supply-chain liability across model developers, platforms, and distributors

CORDA Research Fellow, [Open Democracy](#) Remote Apr 2026 - Present

- **Developed a 16-measure DSA compliance framework** to evaluate whether recommendation algorithms amplify constructive vs outrage-driven content, translating EU DSA Articles 34(1)(a) to (d) into metrics platform auditors can use

SKILLS

Research Methods: In-depth interviews, focus groups, surveys (Qualtrics, SurveyMonkey), usability testing, contextual inquiry, participatory research, diary studies, generative and evaluative research, concept evaluation, mixed-methods, behavioral research, experimental design, AI evaluations

Tools: Dovetail, Marvin, UserTesting, User Interviews, Figma, Maze, Lookback, Looker, Hotjar, Clarity, Brandwatch, R, Python, Cursor, Claude, Gemini, AI Studio, NotebookLM

Domains: Human-AI interaction, trust and safety, responsible AI, recommender systems, social computing, cross-cultural and low-literacy contexts, fintech

Coursework: Ethics, Safety and Social Impact in NLP and LLMs; Design and/of Policy; Statistics and Modelling; User-Centered Research and Evaluation; Measuring Social (CSS)

PUBLICATION

Kowe, K., Shrivastava, P., & Naaman, M. (2026). *Lost in Transcription: Subtitle Errors in Automatic Speech Recognition Reduce Speaker and Content Evaluations*. CHI 2026.

EDUCATION

Carnegie Mellon University , M.S. Human-Computer Interaction, GPA: 4.0	2025 - 2026
Indian Institute of Technology Guwahati , B.Des, GPA: 9.13/10, AIR 29 UCEED	2017 - 2021